

11

Archangel and Neo-Arkhangelsk

Early ...Bb7 and ...Bc5 activity, pressure on e4, and the cost of delaying ...Be7.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will understand Black's active bishop deployment and White's methods for challenging it.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 061 | PAGE 4

Decode: Archangel bishop on b7*An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.*

LESSON 062 | PAGE 8

Play: Archangel bishop on b7*An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.*

LESSON 063 | PAGE 12

Decode: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5*Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.*

LESSON 064 | PAGE 16

Play: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5*Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.*

LESSON 065 | PAGE 20

Decode: White's a4 lever*A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.*

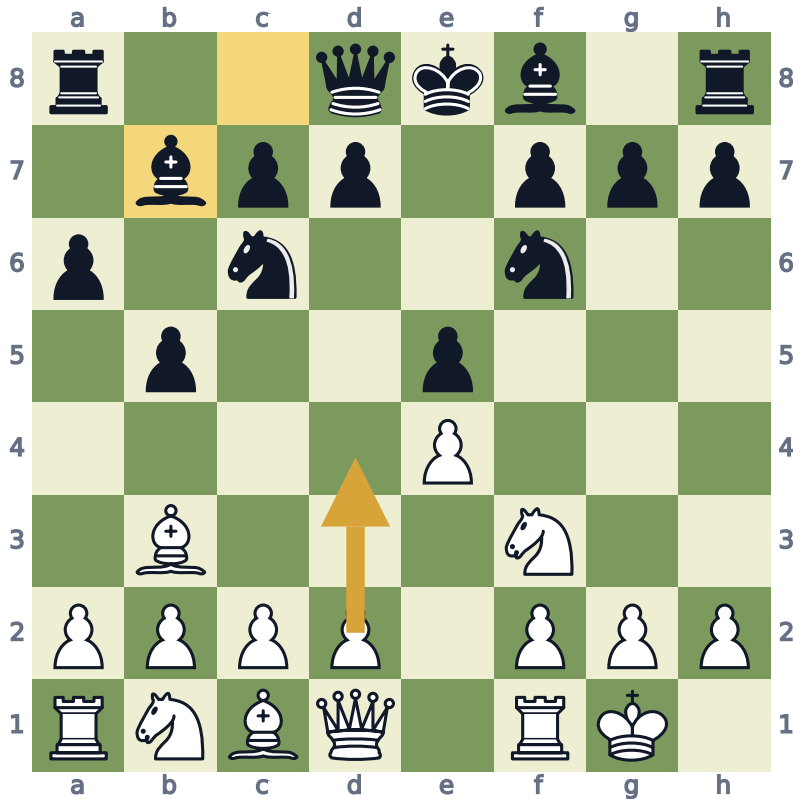
LESSON 066 | PAGE 24

Play: White's a4 lever*A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will understand Black's active bishop deployment and White's methods for challenging it.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Archangel bishop on b7



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

DECISION RULE

Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Keep pressure on e4, castle, and choose ...d6 or ...Bc5 without allowing a central tactic.

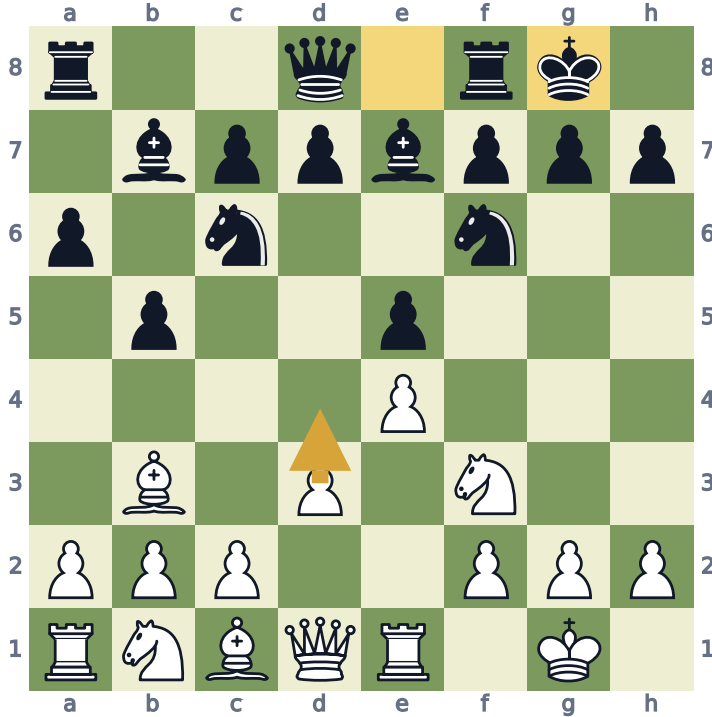
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops.

MEMORY RULE | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

BLACK'S PLAN

Keep pressure on e4, castle, and choose ...d6 or ...Bc5 without allowing a central tactic.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops.

FAILURE MODE

Spending more tempi on queenside pawns while the king remains in the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

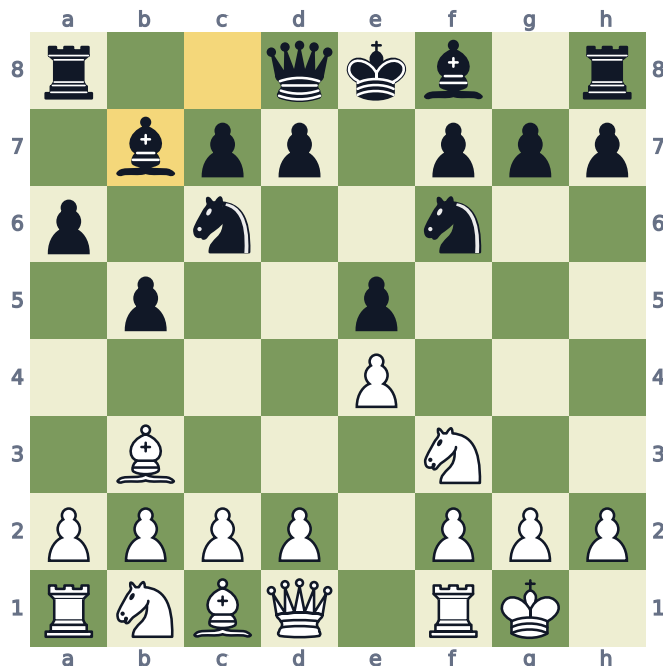
RULE | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Be7 8. Re1 O-O



- Ba4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain? White's resource is: White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops. The line fails as a template when: Spending more tempi on queenside pawns while the king remains in the center.

STORE THIS | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

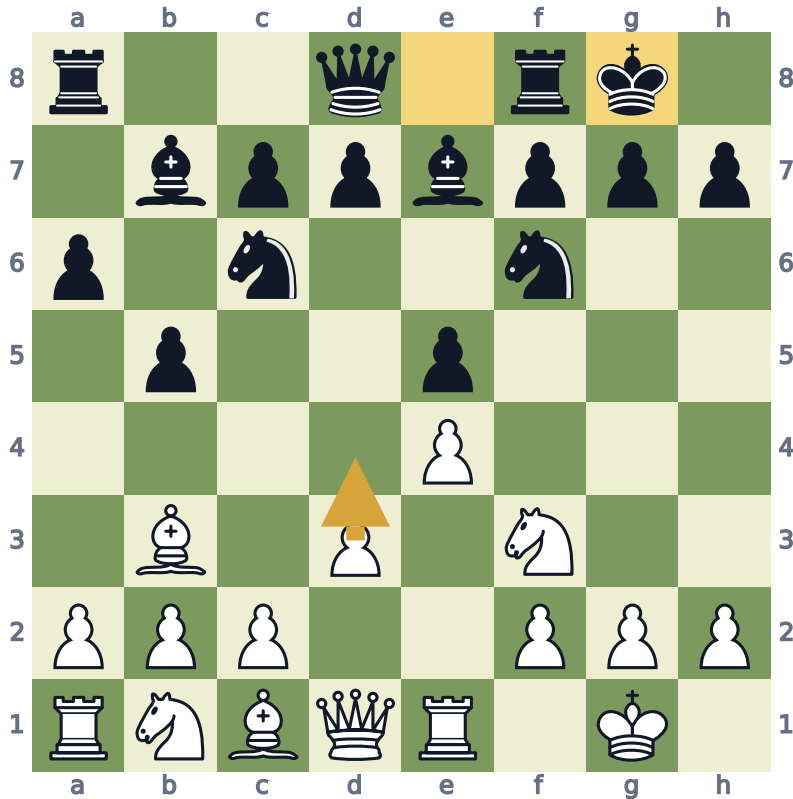
1. ...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves. 2. Keep pressure on e4, castle, and choose ...d6 or ...Bc5 without allowing a central tactic. 3. White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops. 4. Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain? 5. Spending more tempi on queenside pawns while the king remains in the center.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Archangel bishop on b7



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

DECISION RULE

Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Keep pressure on e4, castle, and choose ...d6 or ...Bc5 without allowing a central tactic.

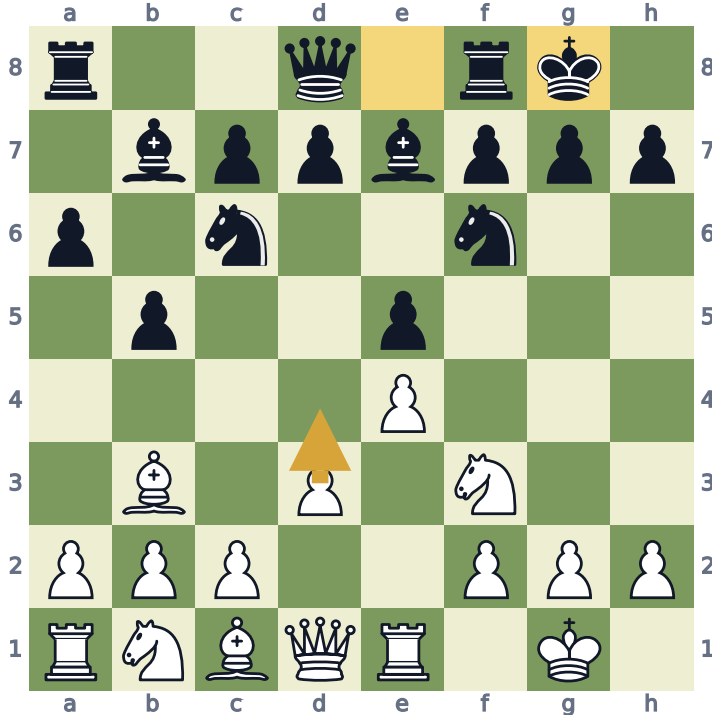
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops.

MEMORY RULE | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

BLACK'S PLAN

Keep pressure on e4, castle, and choose ...d6 or ...Bc5 without allowing a central tactic.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops.

FAILURE MODE

Spending more tempi on queenside pawns while the king remains in the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

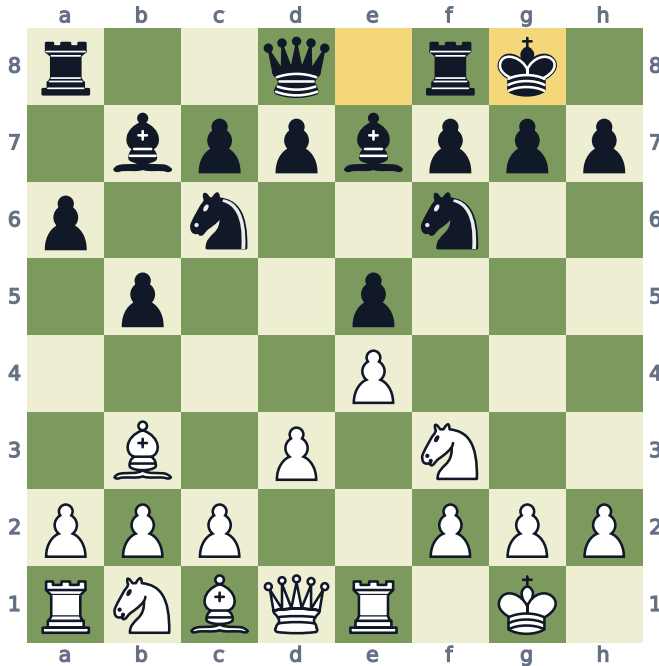
RULE | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Be7 8. Re1 O-O



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Re1: White places a rook behind a file or pawn break expected to become important.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bb7 develops actively against e4 before locking the bishop with ...d6, increasing central pressure at the cost of queenside pawn moves.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain? White's resource is: White supports e4, plays a4 against b5, and prepares c3-d4 to challenge the bishops. The line fails as a template when: Spending more tempi on queenside pawns while the king remains in the center.

STORE THIS | An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

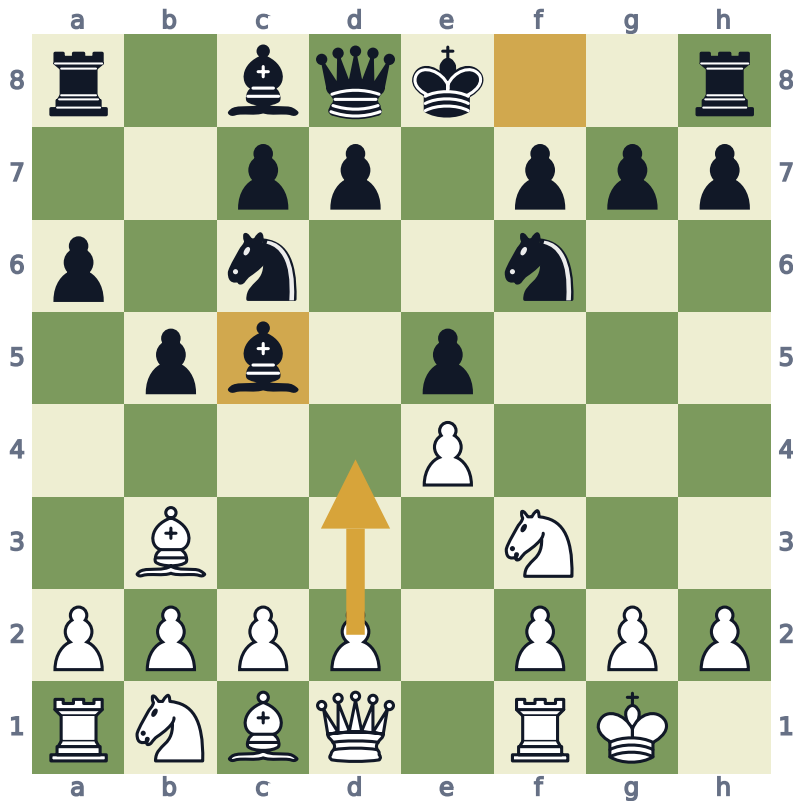
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Be7 8. Re1 O-O

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

DECISION RULE

Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity.

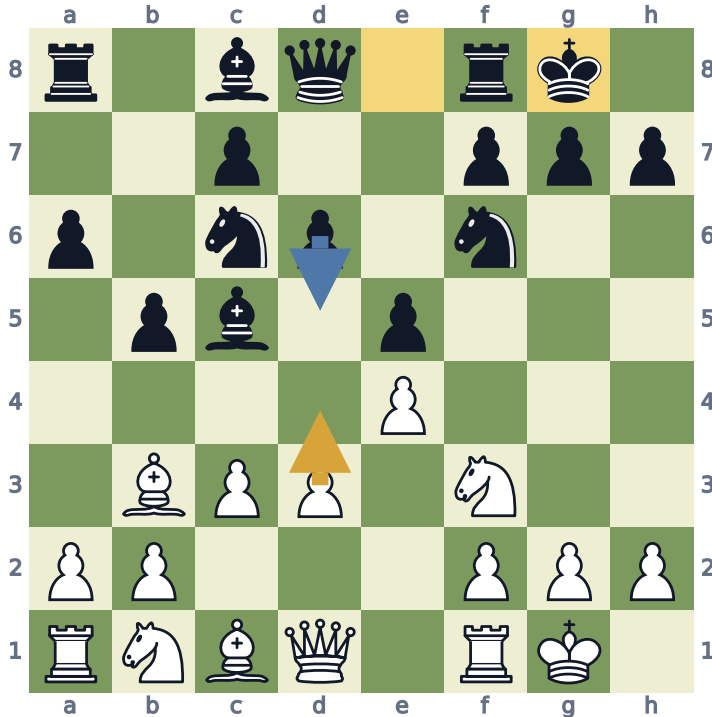
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure.

MEMORY RULE | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

BLACK'S PLAN

Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure.

FAILURE MODE

Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

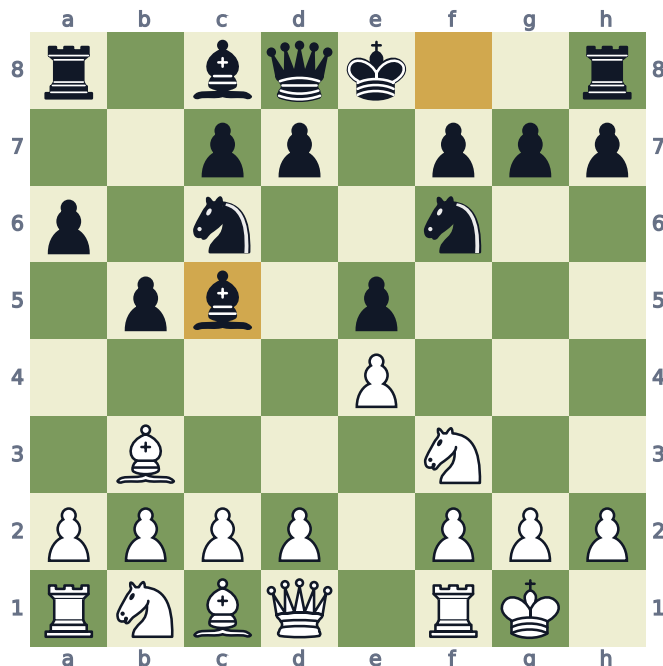
RULE | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bc5 7. d3 d6 8. c3 O-O



- Ba4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc5: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? White's resource is: White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure. The line fails as a template when: Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

STORE THIS | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

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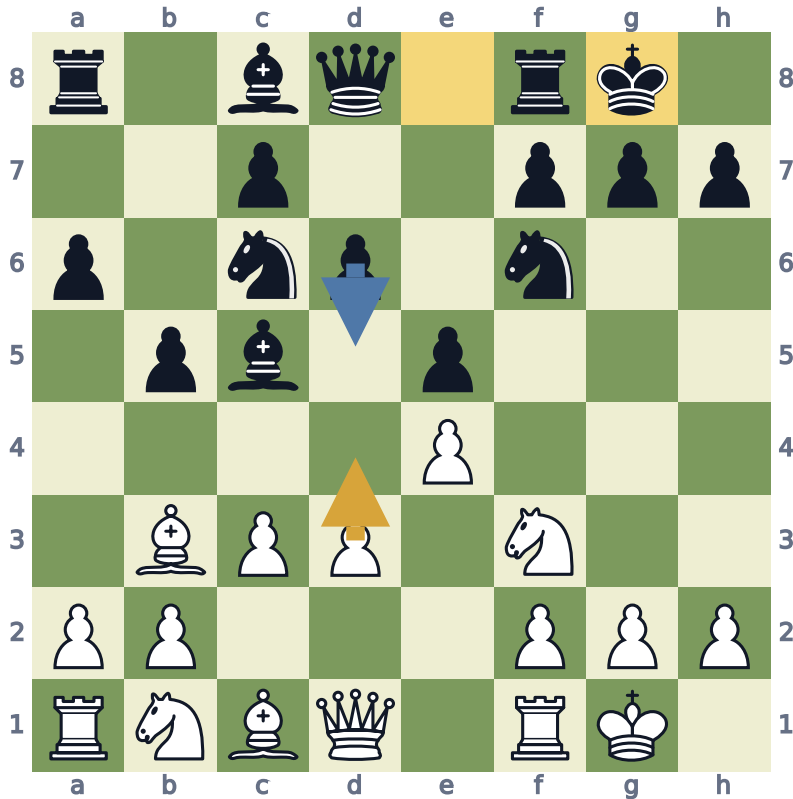
1. ...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure. 2. Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity. 3. White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure. 4. Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? 5. Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bc5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

DECISION RULE

Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity.

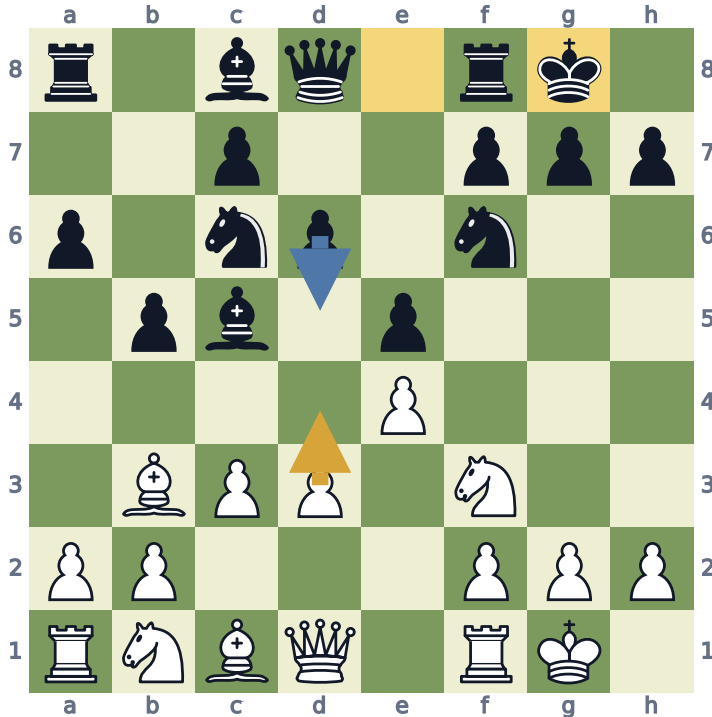
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure.

MEMORY RULE | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

BLACK'S PLAN

Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure.

FAILURE MODE

Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

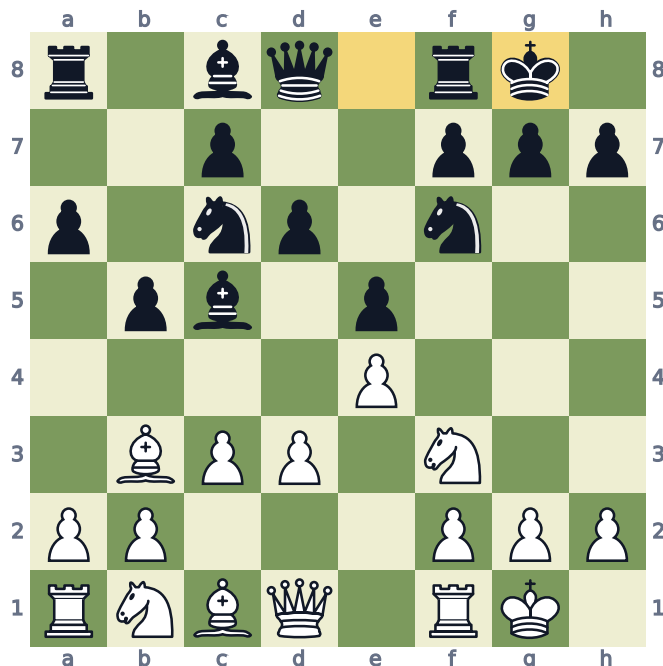
RULE | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bc5 7. d3 d6 8. c3 O-O



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc5: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? White's resource is: White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure. The line fails as a template when: Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

STORE THIS | Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

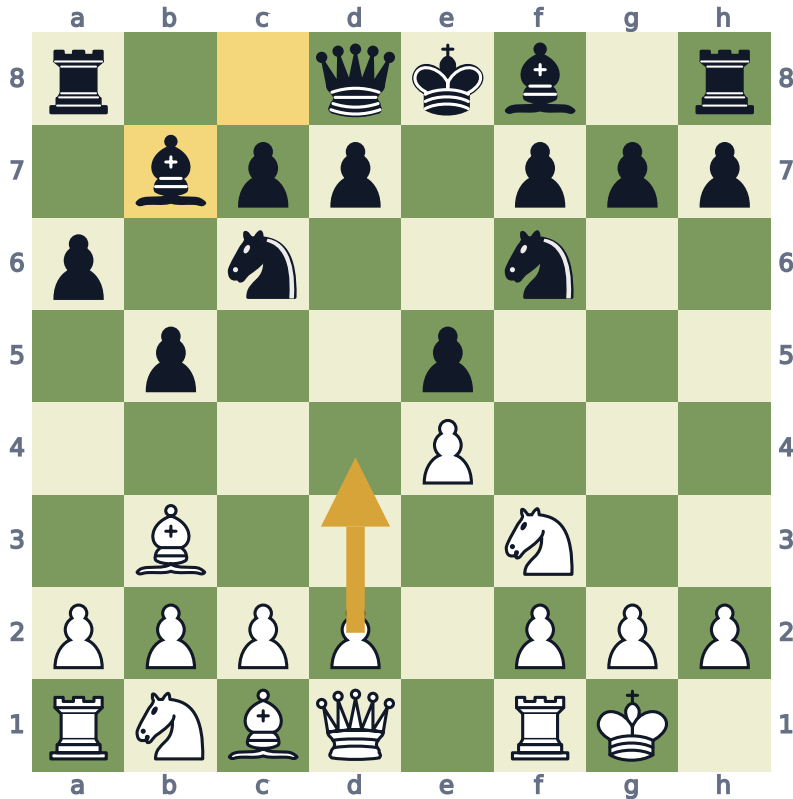
1. ...Bc5 develops outside the pawn chain and eyes f2, producing immediate activity and tactical pressure. 2. Castle quickly, preserve the bishop's influence, and meet d4 with a central choice that keeps activity. 3. White plays c3-d4, a4, or Be3 to challenge the active bishop and queenside structure. 4. Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center? 5. Falling in love with the active bishop and retreating it repeatedly while White develops.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bb3 Bc5 7. d3 d6 8. c3 O-O

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: White's a4 lever



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

DECISION RULE

After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety.

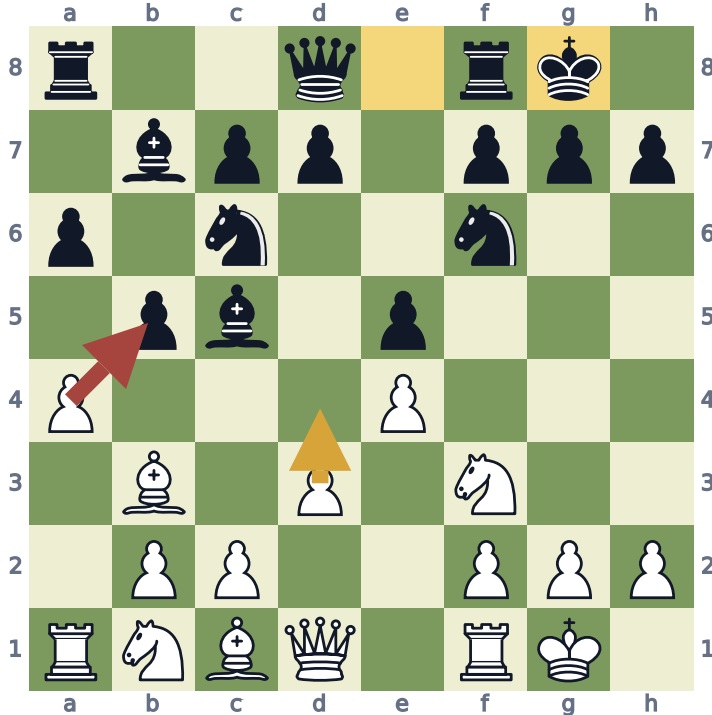
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

BLACK'S PLAN

Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure.

FAILURE MODE

Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

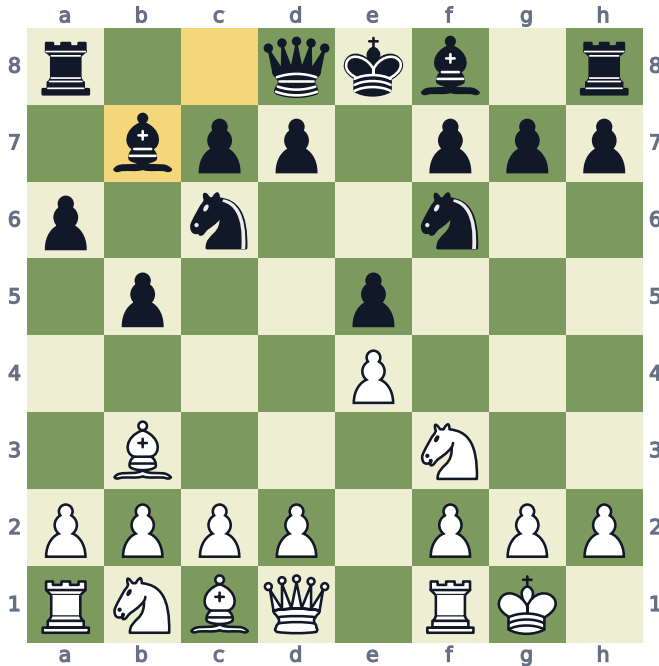
RULE | A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Bc5 8. a4 O-O



- Ba4: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- b5: Black gains bishop tempo and queenside space while creating a possible pawn target.
- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? White's resource is: White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure. The line fails as a template when: Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

STORE THIS | A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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ANSWER KEY

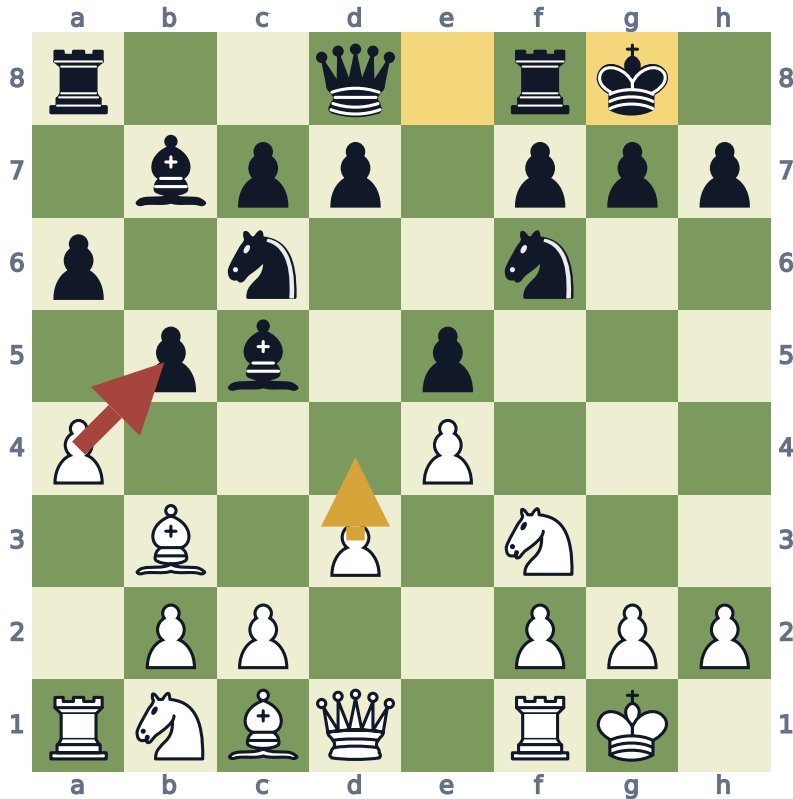
1. a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates. 2. Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety. 3. White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure. 4. After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? 5. Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: White's a4 lever



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

DECISION RULE

After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety.

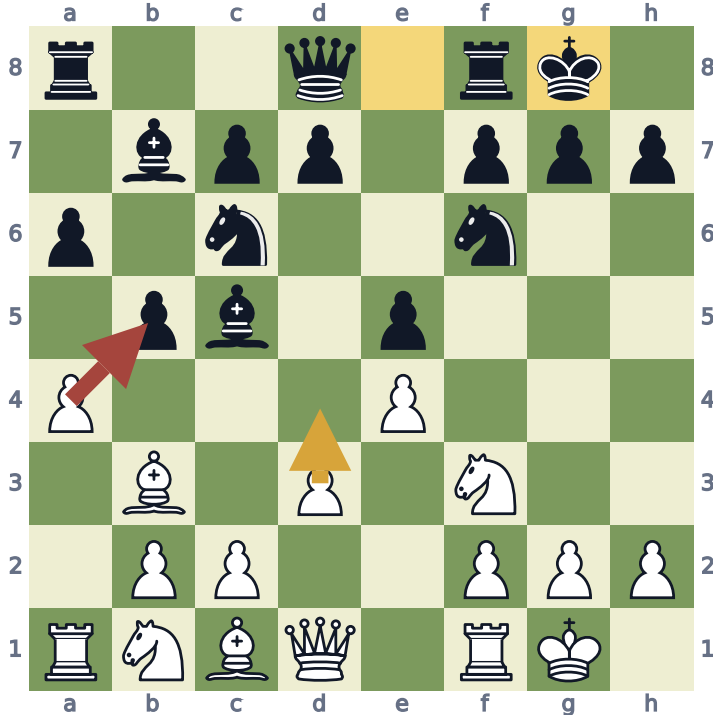
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

BLACK'S PLAN

Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure.

FAILURE MODE

Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

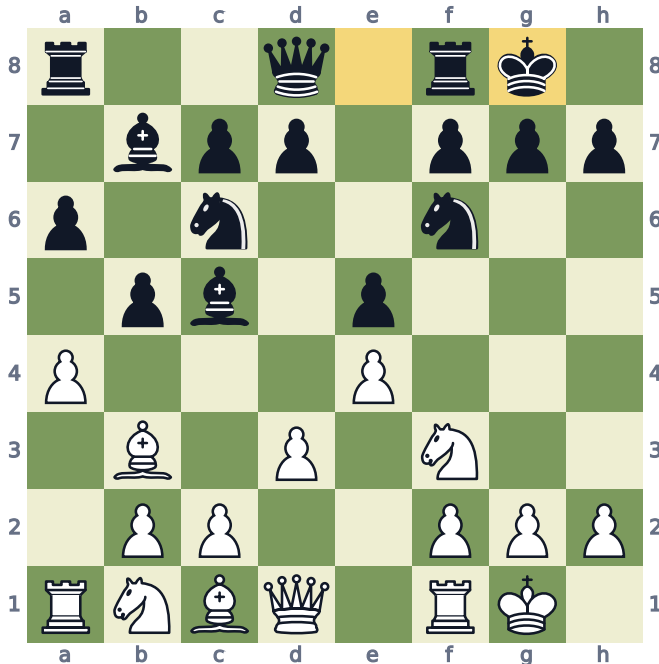
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Bc5 8. a4 O-O



- Bb3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bb7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- d3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Bc5: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- a4: White attacks the queenside pawn chain and tries to create a lasting target.
- O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? White's resource is: White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure. The line fails as a template when: Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

STORE THIS | A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. a4 challenges the advanced b5 pawn and can open the a-file or fix a queenside weakness before Black consolidates. 2. Decide whether to maintain, exchange, or advance the pawn chain based on the resulting files and bishop safety. 3. White opens a queenside file, weakens b5, and distracts Black from central pressure. 4. After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target? 5. Responding to a4 by habit without evaluating the opened file.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Bc5 8. a4 O-O

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 061 Decode: Archangel bishop on b7

Prompt: Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain?

Recall: An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

LESSON 062 Play: Archangel bishop on b7

Prompt: Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain?

Recall: An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

LESSON 063 Decode: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5

Prompt: Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center?

Recall: Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

LESSON 064 Play: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5

Prompt: Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center?

Recall: Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

LESSON 065 Decode: White's a4 lever

Prompt: After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target?

Recall: A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

LESSON 066 Play: White's a4 lever

Prompt: After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target?

Recall: A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Archangel bishop on b7

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Be7 8. Re1 O-O

Decision: Does the b7 bishop create a concrete burden on e4, or is it biting into a defended chain?

Memory: An active diagonal is valuable when it forces the opponent to defend.

CARD 2

Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bc5 7. d3 d6 8. c3 O-O

Decision: Can White gain a useful tempo on the c5 bishop while opening the center?

Memory: Active placement must survive the opponent's central tempo.

CARD 3

White's a4 lever

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Ba4 Nf6 5. O-O b5 6. Bb3 Bb7 7. d3 Bc5 8. a4 O-O

Decision: After axb5 or ...b4, which rook and bishop become better, and which pawn becomes a target?

Memory: A pawn lever is judged by the lines it opens and the targets it leaves.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
061 Decode: Archangel bishop on b7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
062 Play: Archangel bishop on b7	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
063 Decode: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
064 Play: Neo-Arkhangelsk ...Bc5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
065 Decode: White's a4 lever	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
066 Play: White's a4 lever	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.